

David D. Smith

Software Engineer • Paris & SF • France/USA Dual Citizen • Entrepreneur (SIREN 108 203 340)

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Experience

Independent Software Engineering Consultant 5/2018 – present
Security, Reliability, and Efficiency ∇ software projects USA | EU | Japan

Software Engineer, Production 11/2021 – 5/2026
Meta Platforms Menlo Park, CA

AI Training Data Platform 2024 – 2026

- Led migration of AI training platform from bare metal to containerized architecture, reducing fleet size 30% and saving \$200M/year in power.
- Re-architected ZooKeeper coordination layer to support 100K+ node clusters via session sharding.
- Led production engineering team embedded in 50 software engineer AI infrastructure team.

Ads Signals 2021 – 2024

- Led 10:200 PE:SWE partnership during Apple ATT crisis, built privacy-preserving k-anonymity models, recovered ads measurement for opt-out cohorts.
- Rewrote Identity Prediction service (C++ coroutines, tail-at-scale retry), halving latency and delivering \$25M/year in capacity savings.
- Conceived, built novel canary testing against 24hr prod data with synthesized opt-out signals. Verifies regulatory commitments on every commit.
- Unblocked critical prod launch: found $O(n^2)$ JSON decoding bottleneck under live traffic. Company award presented at weekly all-hands, first “Fix of the Week” in 2+ years.

Software Engineer, Platform 4/2019 – 5/2021
NerdWallet Bay Area, On-site/Remote, full-time

- Owned major backend Message Broker service. Ported to Go. 12K QPS, MTBF up 11x.
- Built software dependency management for JS/Py/Go/PHP code with Renovate.
- Implemented SLOs, SLIs, and error budgets with DataDog and Kibana.
- Core contributor to company software engineering best practices and standards.

Senior Information Security Engineer 5/2017 – 2/2018
Ripple San Francisco, CA

- Owned corporate IT security and infrastructure across onsite, AWS, and IBM SoftLayer.
- Drove adoption of OWASP Security Best Practices across Ripple’s SSDLC.

Senior Site Reliability Engineer 10/2007 – 2/2017
Google Bay Area, CA & Tokyo, JP

- GCP AppEngine SRE (2014-2017): Deployed AppEngine to new “miniclust” architecture in Tokyo. On-call for Snapchat, largest GCP customer at the time.
- Cluster Management SRE (2011-2014): Ported Babysitter cluster manager to Google’s main repo. Peer award for killing legacy //depot/google repo.
- SysOps & Goobuntu (2007-2011): Early member of Google SysOps (pre-SRE), owning core corporate infrastructure. Contributed to Linux OSS for TPM support.

Education

West Virginia University College of Arts & Sciences
B.S. Mathematics 12/2004

- Specializations in Cryptography, Linear Algebra & Optimization

West Virginia University College of Engineering
B.S. Computer Science 5/2005

- Specializations in Distributed Systems, Compilers & Numerical Analysis

Yamasa 言語文化学院 Japanese Studies Program
Japanese Language Proficiency Certification • 日本語能力試験 N2 1/2007